

them to a limited set of vendors?

Now, we expect that with FOSSYellowPages.com going LIVE, CIOs and IT heads who were looking for open source vendor support, will be able to take faster decisions.

Q How did you manage to have over 500 organisations listed on the first day of your beta launch?

Well, we were operating in 'Stealth' mode for quite some time. In fact, we have been in the process of compiling the FOSS yellow pages for the print edition of *LINUX For You* magazine for over an year now. We knew that portals like FOSSYellowPages.com need a critical mass of registered organisations; hence we launched this portal in beta mode only after crossing the threshold of 500 registered organisations, and after verifying the contact details of over a 100 firms.

Q What is the cost of listing my organisation on FOSSYellowPages.com?

The cost is zero. And, we intend to keep it like that in the future too. The idea is to provide a platform for IT decision-makers to have an overview of open source related solution providers, and get easy access to them.

Q What kind of firm qualifies to get listed on FOSSYellowPages.com?

Any organisation that provides support for an open source solution qualifies. For example, if you can help a customer who is looking for an enterprise communications solution or a business intelligence solution using open source, you should be listed here.

Q Can a freelancer/consultant get listed on FOSSYellowPages.com too?

Yes, not as an individual but under the name of a firm. Also, freelancers must make sure their profiles clearly indicate the size and nature of their firms. Otherwise, if our research team finds out that the profiles of those listed do not present an accurate picture, they could be blacklisted, which means that customers would hesitate to trust these organisations.

Q If our organisation uses open source tools to develop software, can we get listed?

Using open source for software development is not a criterion to get listed. In fact, any software development organisation that does not use open source stacks for software development is doing so at its own risk.

The main question to ask yourself is that if a customer asks your firm to develop a solution using a certain open source stack/project, do you have the expertise to provide it. If yes, list yourself, and make sure that your organisation gets selected for those open source projects.

Q The registration page has asked only a limited set of questions. How do I upload the rest of the information?

To keep the registration process simple we have restricted the number of questions asked. However, once you register and

Registration page

authenticate yourself, then you will be able to login to your account, and access the 'MyAccount' section, where you will be able to update all the remaining information. Plus, whenever we introduce new information options (data fields), you will get to see those in your 'MyAccount' and be able to update those too.

Q What are the important details that should be provided to generate serious business enquiries?

Besides the basic contact details of your firm and the key personnel (try to provide as much information as possible), the most important information is the list of FOSS projects that your organisation supports. However, please do NOT select FOSS projects that you have NOT implemented at a customer site, because in the next phase, we are going to ask you to name at least one client for whom you have installed that solution (with contact details). Of course, you will have the option not to share your customers' contact details with everyone who accesses your website.

Q What is the logic behind the order in which the organisations are listed?

As of now, most listings are in alphabetical order. However, soon we will introduce the FYP score, where organisations will be listed in the order of their FYP score—those with the highest scores appearing first.

This FYP score will be calculated based on many parameters (and we will be transparent about them). Some of these will include:

- The amount of information you share (a zero-cost option open to all);
- The levels of verification your organisation has earned (initially a FREE service, but soon this will be a paid feature);